Banda-‘alī and Bābā Sairāmī said, ‘The horses have had no corn for two days and two nights; let us go down into the dale and put them there to graze.’ Accordingly, they rode down and put them near the green grass. It was around afternoon prayer, that a horseman passed along the rising ground where they had been. He was Qādīr-bīrdī, the headman of Ghawā. Babur instructed Banda-‘alī and Bābā Sairāmī to ‘call him’.[*]

He came running after hearing the call. Babur interrogated him for some time, showered enough favours and showed kindness. Babur made promises and spoke fair words. And then Babur sent him to bring rope, a grass hook, an axe, corn for the horses, food, more horses, and material for crossing water (reeds for the raft).

Around the time of evening prayer, a horseman passed from the direction of Karnān for Ghawā. Babur inquired about his identity. Perhaps he was Muḥammad Bāqir Beg himself, on his way from where he was seen earlier by Babur going at nightfall to some other hiding place. But while replying he changed his voice and Babur couldn’t recognize him although he had been with him for several years. Babur has mentioned in the *Baburnama* that ‘It would have been well if I had recognized him, and he had joined me. His passing caused much anxiety and alarm; tryst could not be kept with Qādīr-bīrdī of Ghawā.’ Banda-‘alī said, ‘There are retired gardens in the suburbs of Karnān where no one will suspect us of being; let us go there and send to Qādīr-bīrdī and have him brought there.’ To implement this idea, Babur and the rest went to the Karnān suburbs.

It was a very chilly winter day. On the way, Banda-‘alī and Bābā Sairāmī found a used, coarse sheepskin coat, which they brought to Babur. He put it on without thinking twice as winter was biting his skin deep. They also brought Babur a bowl of millet porridge which he ate as a treat for refreshment. ‘Have you sent off the man to Qādīr-bīrdī?’ Babur asked Banda-‘alī. He replied by nodding his head, ‘I have sent.’ However, they may not have done so in reality, instead, they had agreed together to send the man to Taṃbal in Akhsī. Babur has made this observation in the *Baburnama*.

Then, they entered an abandoned and unused house that they saw on the way. Babur slept there for some time. Banda-‘alī and Bābā Sairāmī said to Babur, ‘You must not bestir yourself to leave Karnān till there is news of Qādīr-bīrdī but this house is right among the suburbs; on the outskirts the orchards are empty; no-one will suspect if we go there.’